"Because it comes from somewhere deep inside you," Salim whispered. "From deep inside here!" and he pointed to his heart.

The old man looked at the boy surprised. He saw him **blush** and turn his face away.

"You are right, Salim, you are right." And then he added with sudden bitterness, "And if you don't have it here," he thumped his chest, " Then you'd better go to Agra and mass produce ashtrays for tourists from abroad. Then..." The old man coughed painfully and reached for his glass of water.

"Eat, Masterjee, eat. Everything will be alright."

After he had eaten, the old man once again took up his hammer and chisel. He worked till late in the night. In the early hours of the morning the chisel fell from his hand and the hammer dropped to the ground. His old body sagged, falling forward limply. His forehead struck Krishna's flute and slid down the statue to rest on the pedestal.

"Hai Ram," he muttered, and sank into a comfortable darkness.

When he opened his eyes, he found himself lying on a cot in his bedroom, covered by a light cotton blanket.

GLOSSARY

serene	-	calm
blurred	-	became unclear
blush	-	show shyness

Read the sentences and number them in correct order.

1. He wished to have Gopal with him. ☐
2. Salim felt that it should come from within. ☐
3. He thought he wouldn't be able to finish it. ☐
4. The old man worked tirelessly on the sculpture. ☐
5. He realized that Gopal must learn to carve the finer details. ☐
6. He had a strong wish to finish it in time. ☐
7. Over days, he felt very weak. ☐

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